LESSON 4

# Ode to Joy

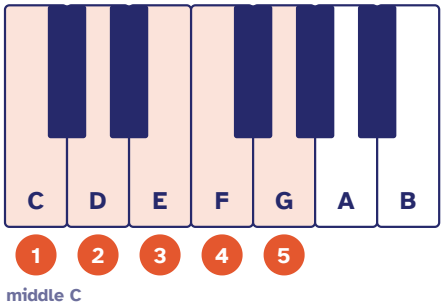
A tune from Beethoven's Ninth Symphony, first played in Vienna in 1824. The words here are our own.

IN THIS SONG **the staff** **the Queen's sign** **five fingers: C to G** **4/4**

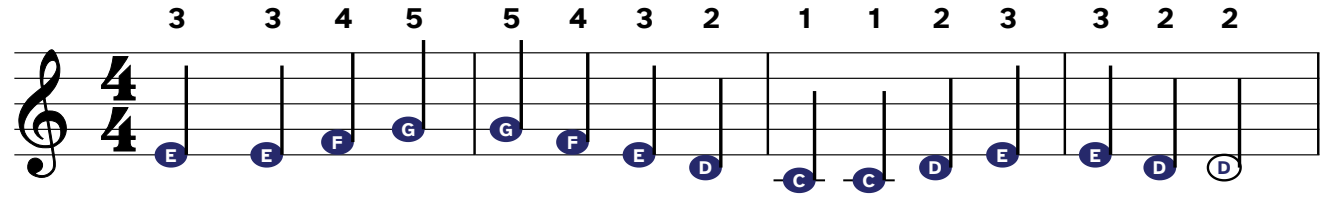
LISTEN FIRST
Scan the code: listen to the whole song once, then hum along the second time.

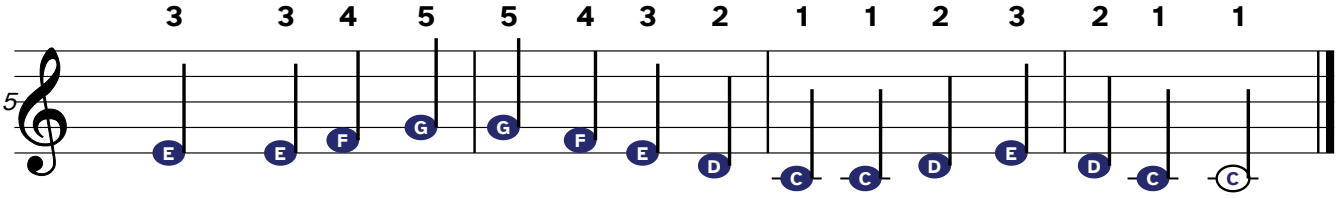
## 1 Meet the song

Listen, pointing to each note. Sing it with the words, then on the letter names.




**Your hand: the C position.** Thumb on middle C, a finger on each key up to G: all five.
**The staff arrives.** Five lines, and the Queen's sign at the start: her curl wraps round line 2, the note G. The letters still sit inside the notes.




☐ Listened and pointed ☐ Sang it with the words ☐ Sang the letter names

## 2 Take it apart

The same song, one piece at a time: first its rhythm, then its notes.

### THE RHYTHM

Say the words in time, then clap them and count: clap on the coral numbers, hold through the grey ones.

**THE TIME**

4/4

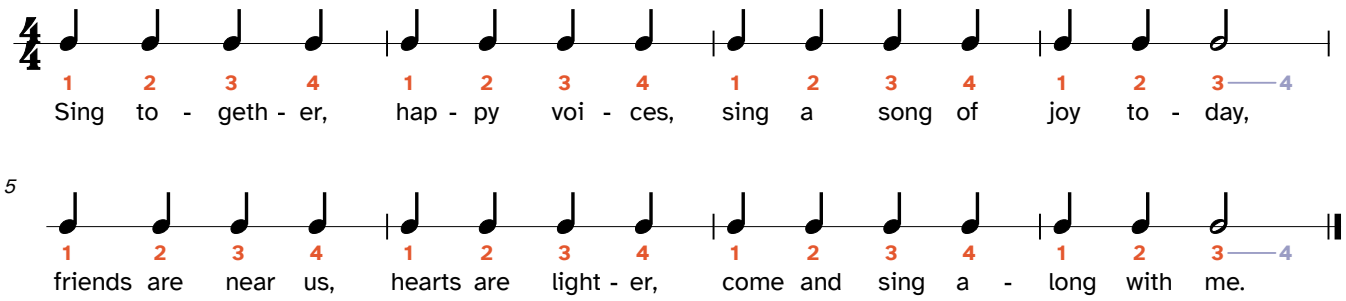
**Top 4:** four beats in every bar.

**Bottom 4:** a crotchet is one beat.

**THE NOTES**

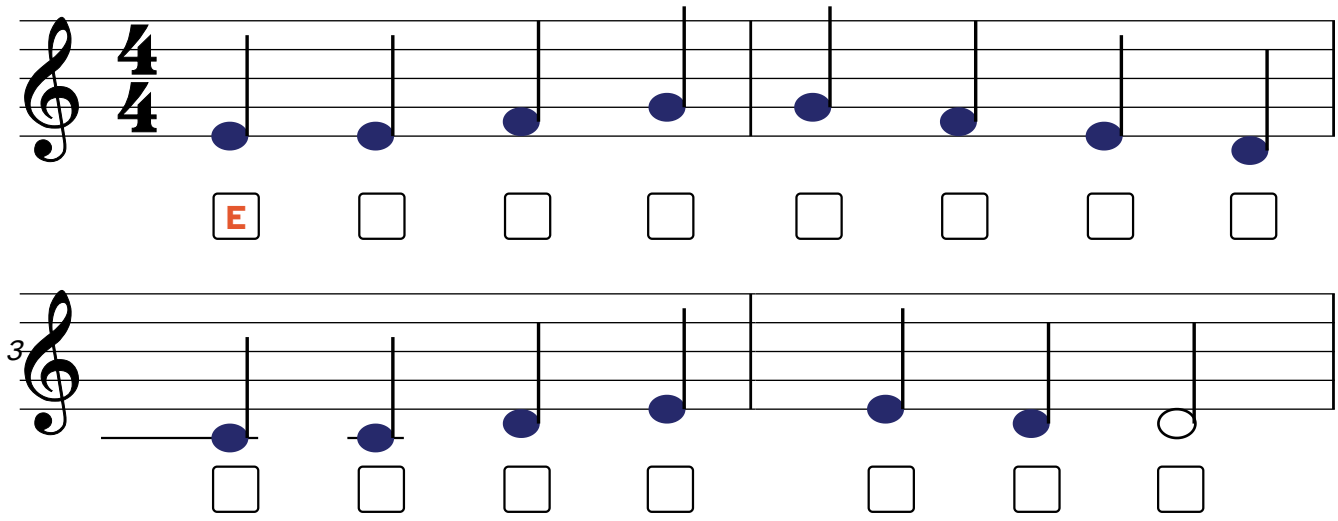
**crotchet: walk** — 1 beat ●

**minim: hold** — 2 beats ●●




### THE NOTES

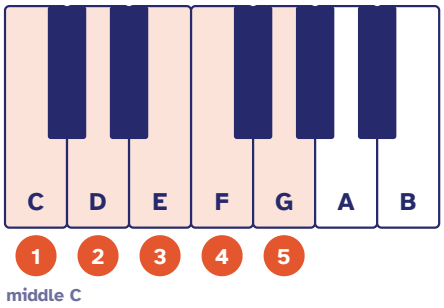
On the staff now: write the letter name under each note of the first four bars. E sits on the bottom line; G on line 2.




- ☐ **Said it in time**
- ☐ **Clapped and counted**
- ☐ **Wrote the letter names**
- ☐ **Found E and G on their lines**

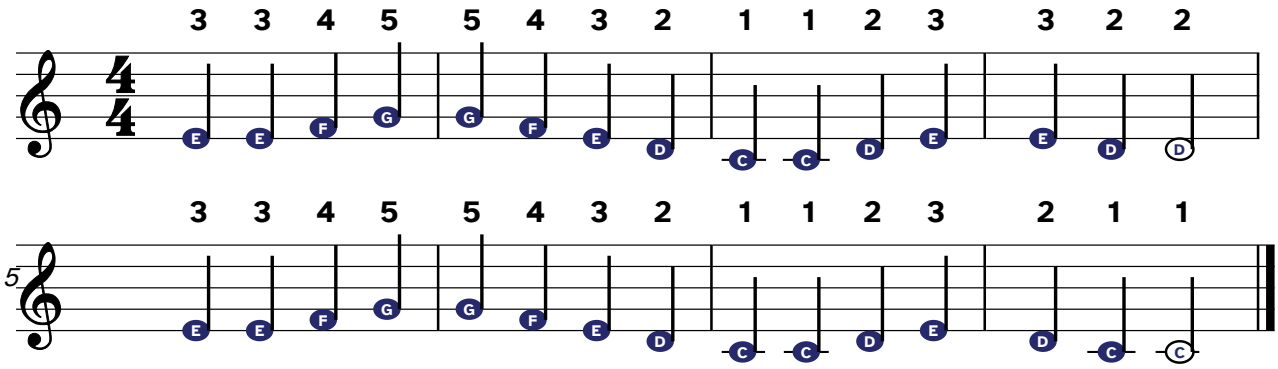
## 3 Play it

All five fingers in the C position: the right hand, then the left.

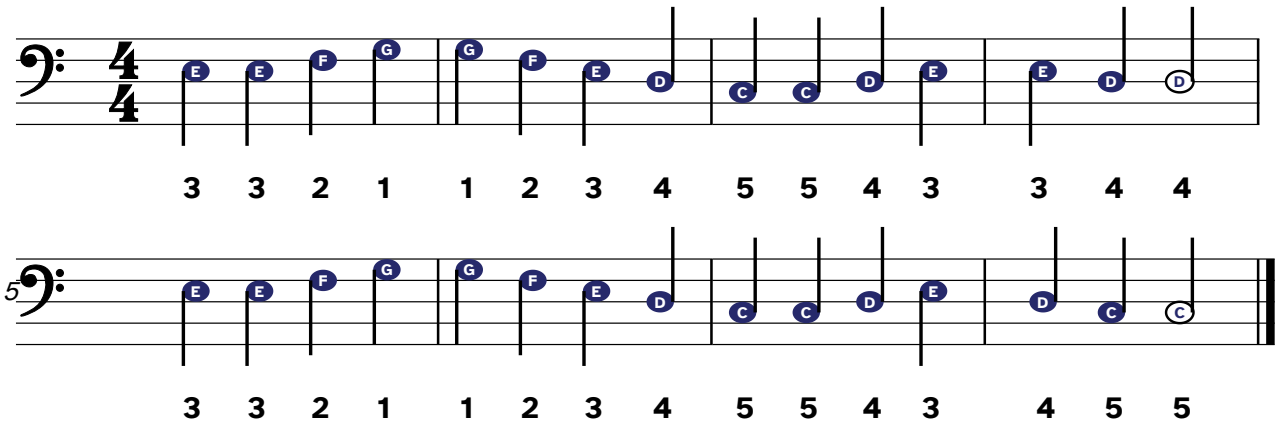



**Right hand:** thumb on middle C, 1 2 3 4 5 up to G. **Left hand:** an octave lower, on the King's staff: his sign's two dots wrap round F. Thumb on G, down to 5 on C.

**R RIGHT HAND** the C position




**L LEFT HAND** the King's staff, an octave lower




**4 · CHECK**

- ☐ I can say and clap it
- ☐ I can sing it with the words
- ☐ I can find E and G on the staff

I can play it:

- ☐ Right hand ☐ Left hand

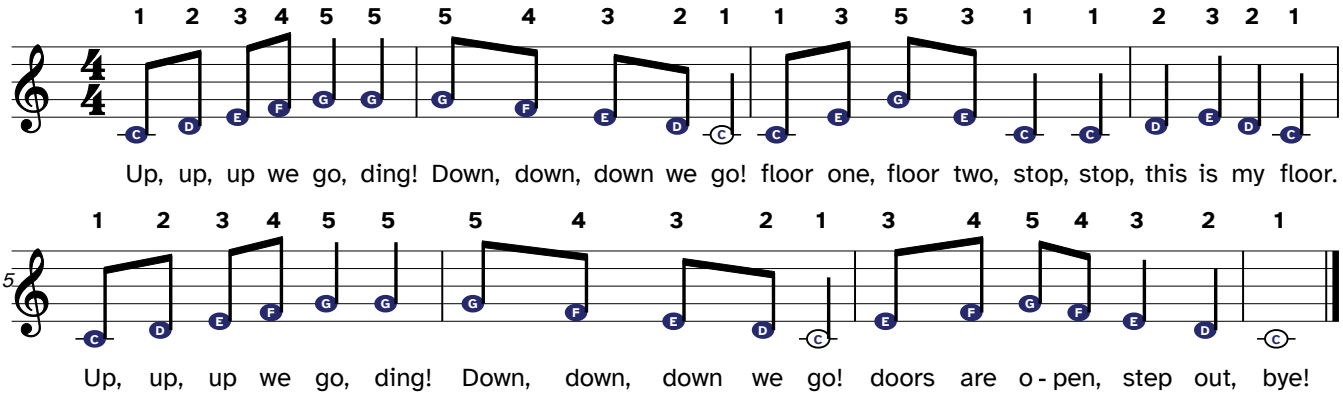
TEACHER ☐ Pass ☐ Not yet

# + More to play

Use what this lesson taught in new ways, then take a first look at the next lesson.

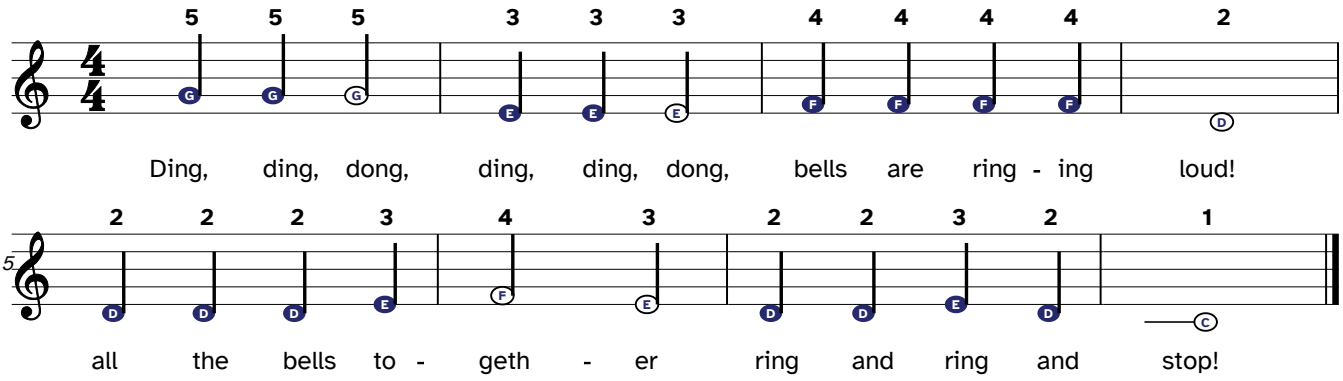
## THE LIFT

A lift ride, quick and cheerful: all five fingers run up to G and back down, then hop between floors.



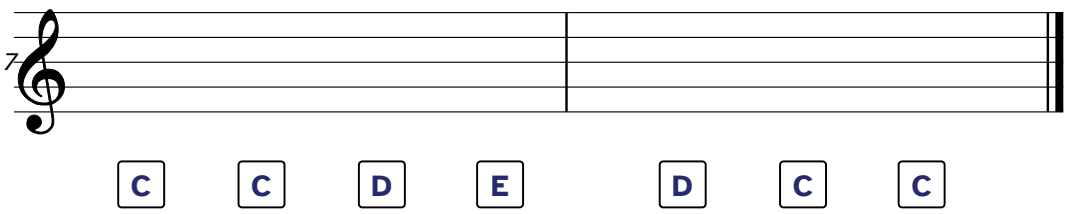

## RING THE BELLS

Bright and ringing, a peek at Lesson 5: the same note again and again, then long notes to hold.




## DRAW IT ON THE STAFF

The letter names are in the boxes. Draw each note above its box, on its line or in its space: C on its own little line under the staff, D just under the bottom line, E on the bottom line.



| C | C | D | E | D | C | C |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|

☐ **Played the first tune** ☐ **Played the second tune** ☐ **Drew the notes on the staff**